

Acme Corporation — HR & Employment Policy Manual

Comprehensive Guide to Employment Conditions, Leave, Performance, and Conduct
Acme Corporation | Human Resources Department | Effective: January 1, 2026 | Version 4.1

1. Purpose, Scope, and Governing Law

This Human Resources and Employment Policy Manual ('the Policy') constitutes the official and legally binding framework for all employment-related matters at Acme Corporation ('the Company'). This Policy applies to every full-time employee, part-time employee, intern, and temporary staff member engaged by the Company, across all domestic and international offices.

This Policy supersedes all prior versions of any HR handbook, memo, oral understanding, or written communication relating to employment conditions. The Company reserves the right to revise, amend, or rescind any provision of this Policy at any time, with changes communicated via official Workday notification or company-wide email broadcast.

IMPORTANT: Non-compliance with any policy in this manual may result in disciplinary action up to and including immediate termination of employment for cause, irrespective of seniority or role level.

2. The Onboarding & Pre-Boarding Process

Acme Corp is deeply invested in providing every new team member with a structured, meaningful, and compliance-ready onboarding experience. This process begins the moment a candidate accepts their offer and extends through their 90-day probationary review.

2.1 Pre-Boarding Documentation (Days -14 to Day 0)

Before any new hire can access company systems, physical premises, or proprietary information, the following documents **MUST** be fully executed and verified by the HR Onboarding Specialist:

1. Signed Official Offer Letter (countersigned by HR Director)
2. Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) — **CRITICAL**. System access cannot be provisioned until this is received.
3. Intellectual Property Assignment Agreement — assigns all work product created during employment to Acme Corp.
4. Code of Business Conduct and Ethics Acknowledgment Form
5. Form I-9 with valid supporting identity documents (Passport or Driver's License + Social Security Card)
6. Bank details for direct deposit configuration
7. Emergency contact information (minimum two contacts with phone numbers)

COMPLIANCE NOTE: Failure to collect the signed NDA before Day 1 is a reportable HR incident. The IT Department will not provision any accounts until HR formally marks pre-boarding as complete in Workday.

2.2 Day 1 Procedures

The hiring manager is responsible for sending a formal introductory 'Welcome Email' to the departmental distribution list at 8:00 AM on the employee's first day. This email must include the employee's name, title, and start date.

The new hire must attend the mandatory two-hour HR Orientation Session conducted via Zoom at 10:00 AM. This session covers company values, benefits enrollment, security protocols, and an introduction to the HRIS system (Workday).

By 3:00 PM on Day 1, the employee must log into Workday to complete their W-4 tax withholding election form and configure their direct deposit routing information. Benefits enrollment must be completed within the first 30 days of employment.

2.3 The 90-Day Probationary Period

All new employees serve a 90-day probationary period. During this period: - Manager and employee must hold weekly 1-on-1 meetings (minimum 30 minutes each) - A formal written review must be conducted at the 30-day, 60-day, and 90-day marks - Accrued PTO cannot be used until the 90-day period is successfully completed - Either party may terminate employment during this period with 48 hours' written notice

3. Paid Time Off (PTO), Sick Leave, and Holiday Policy

Acme Corp provides a generous and flexible PTO program designed to support employee wellbeing and work-life balance.

3.1 PTO Accrual and Usage

Full-time exempt employees accrue PTO at a rate of 1.5 days per completed month of service, totaling 18 days (144 hours) per calendar year. Part-time employees accrue PTO on a pro-rated basis.

Accrual begins on Day 1 of employment, but newly hired employees may not use any PTO until the successful completion of their 90-day probationary period. PTO requests must be submitted in Workday with a minimum of 5 business days' advance notice for absences of 3 days or fewer, and a minimum of 14 business days for absences exceeding 3 days.

PTO balances may carry over from one calendar year to the next, up to a maximum of 10 days (80 hours). Any balance exceeding this cap will be forfeited on January 1st of each new year.

3.2 Sick Leave

All full-time employees receive 10 days (80 hours) of paid sick leave per calendar year, effective immediately upon hire. Sick leave may be used for the employee's own illness or injury, or for caring for a spouse, domestic partner, child, or parent. Sick leave does not accrue and does not carry over year to year.

For absences due to illness spanning more than 3 consecutive business days, the employee must obtain and submit a signed physician's note to HR within 48 hours of returning to work. Failure to provide documentation will result in the absence being coded as unpaid.

3.3 Company Holidays

Acme Corp observes 11 paid federal holidays per year. Additionally, each employee receives 2 floating holidays annually that can be used at any time with manager approval. A full list of observed holidays is published on the company intranet by November 1st of each year.

4. Leaves of Absence (LOA) — Extended and Unpaid Leave

Acme Corp recognizes that employees may require extended time away from work for significant life events. The Company provides several categories of formal leave in compliance with applicable state and federal laws.

4.1 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

Eligible employees (those with at least 12 months of service and 1,250 hours worked in the previous year) may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave per year under the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) for qualifying reasons, including the birth or adoption of a child, serious health conditions, or care for a qualifying family member.

FMLA requests must be submitted via the Workday HRIS portal a minimum of 30 days in advance of the anticipated start date, except in cases of unforeseeable medical emergencies. HR will provide an FMLA designation notice within 5 business days of receiving the request.

4.2 Parental Leave

All new parents — regardless of gender or role — are entitled to 16 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or placement of a child. This leave runs concurrently with FMLA leave. Parental leave must begin within 12 months of the qualifying event.

4.3 IT Notification and License Suspension

MANDATORY PROCESS: Upon HR approval of any LOA exceeding 30 continuous calendar days, the HR Operations team **MUST** notify the IT Department within 24 hours. IT is required to immediately suspend all non-essential software licenses (e.g., Salesforce, Adobe Creative Cloud, GitHub Enterprise licenses, Datadog seats) for the duration of the leave period. This is mandatory to reduce unnecessary software expenditure. Upon return, IT must restore all licenses within 1 business day.

4.4 Return-to-Work

Prior to returning from any LOA, the employee must notify their manager and HR a minimum of 5 business days in advance. For medical leaves, a physician's clearance-to-return note is required before the employee may resume work.

5. Performance Management and Improvement Plans (PIP)

Acme Corp holds its employees to the highest standards of professional performance and conduct. When an employee's performance consistently fails to meet the established expectations for their role, the Company will initiate a structured improvement process.

5.1 Informal Coaching (Pre-PIP Stage)

Before a formal PIP is initiated, the manager should first attempt informal coaching over a period of 2 to 4 weeks. Informal coaching must be documented in manager meeting notes and referenced if a formal

PIP is subsequently required.

5.2 Initiating a Formal PIP

A formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is initiated jointly by the direct manager and the HR Business Partner. The standard PIP duration is 30 days for critical performance failures or 60 days for ongoing deficiencies. The PIP document must contain: 1. A precise description of performance gaps, citing specific, dated examples with measurable evidence. 2. Clearly defined, SMART goals (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) the employee must reach by the PIP conclusion date. 3. A mandatory schedule of weekly 1-on-1 check-in meetings with the manager. Monthly check-ins are insufficient and not compliant with this policy. 4. Required resources and support the Company will provide to help the employee succeed. 5. A clear statement of consequences: if goals are not met, disciplinary action up to and including termination may result.

Both the employee and the manager must physically sign the PIP document to acknowledge its commencement. The signed copy is filed in the employee's official HR record.

5.3 Successful PIP Completion

If the employee meets all defined goals within the PIP period, a written notice of successful completion is placed in their HR file. The employee returns to standard performance management cycles. However, any recurrence of similar performance issues within 12 months may result in immediate termination without a second PIP.

6. Internal Role Transfers and Promotions

Acme Corp is strongly committed to internal career mobility and encourages employees to explore growth opportunities within the Company before seeking roles externally.

6.1 Transfer Eligibility

An employee is eligible to apply for an internal transfer if they meet all of the following conditions: - They have been in their current role for a minimum of 12 consecutive months. - Their most recent performance review rating is 'Meets Expectations' or higher. - They are not currently on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP). - They have obtained informal endorsement from their current manager.

6.2 Transfer Execution

Upon mutual approval by both the current manager and the receiving manager, a formal transfer date is agreed upon. The transition period between roles must not exceed 14 calendar days.

During this period: the transferring employee must finalize all outstanding work items; the current manager must approve a Knowledge Transfer Document (KTD) capturing critical institutional knowledge; and the IT IAM team must be formally notified by HR to audit and update the employee's access rights.

IT must revoke access to the former department's sensitive shared drives, Slack channels, and cloud resources, while simultaneously granting appropriate access for the new department.

6.3 Compensation Adjustment

All transfers that involve a title change or a change in scope of responsibilities will be reviewed for a compensation adjustment. HR will issue a new, signed Offer Addendum detailing the updated title, salary band, and effective date. The employee must sign this document before the transfer date.

7. Employee Offboarding — Voluntary Resignation and Involuntary Termination

Acme Corp's offboarding process is strictly regulated to protect intellectual property, ensure data security, and remain compliant with all applicable employment laws.

7.1 Resignation Process

Employees wishing to resign must submit a formal written resignation letter to their direct manager and the HR Department. The standard notice period expected is 2 weeks (10 business days). Senior Director level and above are expected to provide 4 weeks' notice.

Upon receipt of a resignation letter, HR must immediately open an 'Offboarding Master Ticket' in Jira Service Management to coordinate all downstream tasks.

7.2 Knowledge Transfer Obligation

The departing employee's manager is responsible for ensuring a comprehensive Knowledge Transfer Document (KTD) is completed and uploaded to the department's shared Google Drive at least 3 business days prior to the departure date. Failure to ensure completion of the KTD will reflect in the manager's own performance review.

7.3 IT Access Revocation

The IT Security Operations Center (SOC) must be formally notified via the Jira Offboarding Ticket to schedule the revocation of all system access. This includes: Okta SSO (which cascades to all integrated apps), Slack, Google Workspace, Corporate VPN, AWS, GitHub, and any physical network access points.

MANDATORY: Access revocation must be scheduled to execute at EXACTLY 5:00 PM local time on the employee's final day. Access must never be left active after 5:00 PM on a departure day, or over a weekend following a departure.

7.4 Asset Recovery

All company assets must be returned before the conclusion of the Exit Interview. This includes: corporate laptop, laptop power adapter, external monitor, peripherals, building access badge, corporate credit card, and any other company property.

For fully remote employees, HR must dispatch a pre-paid, insured FedEx shipping box to the employee's registered home address no later than 5 business days before the final day, along with packing instructions.

7.5 Exit Interview and Final Payroll

HR must schedule and conduct a 30-minute structured Exit Interview on or before the employee's final day. The interview is used to gather confidential feedback regarding the employee's experience at Acme Corp.

The Payroll Department must process the final paycheck — including the payout of all unused, accrued PTO balance — within 48 hours of the official termination date, or in compliance with the specific requirements of the state labor law governing the employee's work location.

7.6 Laptop Wiping Protocol

All returned laptops must be completely wiped by IT Logistics prior to being re-issued to any new employee. The wiping process must conform to DoD 5220.22-M standard erasure protocols. Failure to perform this wipe is a critical security violation.

8. Anti-Harassment, Non-Discrimination, and Inclusion

Acme Corp is unconditionally committed to maintaining a workplace free from all forms of discrimination, harassment, bullying, and retaliation. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment.

8.1 Prohibited Conduct

Harassment of any employee based on race, color, national origin, ancestry, religion, creed, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, age, disability, marital status, military status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law is strictly prohibited and will not be tolerated under any circumstances.

8.2 Mandatory Training

All new employees must complete the interactive 'Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion in the Modern Workplace' e-learning module within their first 14 days of employment. Corporate network access will be automatically suspended for employees who fail to complete this training by the deadline.

All managers must complete an additional 'Inclusive Leadership and Unconscious Bias' training module within their first 30 days of assuming a management role.

8.3 Reporting Procedures

Any employee who experiences or witnesses conduct that may constitute harassment or discrimination is encouraged to report it through any of the following channels: directly to their HR Business Partner; via the anonymous Ethics Hotline at 1-800-ACME-ETH; or through the confidential web portal at ethics.acmecorp.internal.